

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

Tactics and Calculation in 1.d4 2.c4 Positions

Opening-specific geometry, central breaks, candidate moves, and blunder control

TRAINING WORKBOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

Workbook Method

Attempt each page before reopening the matching course-book chapter. Speak answers aloud or write them. The self-score rewards a clear decision rule and the opponent's best reply, not a lucky move guess.

REVIEW THRESHOLD

8-10: review in one week. 5-7: review tomorrow. 0-4: reread the course chapter now, then retry from a blank board.

Use the workbook again after a game reaches a related structure. Real-game retrieval is the final test.

01. Loose Pieces Tell the Truth



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Many opening tactics begin with an undefended or overloaded piece.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. e3 Nf6 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. a3 a6 7. dxc5 Bxc5 8. b4 Bd6 9. Bb2 O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

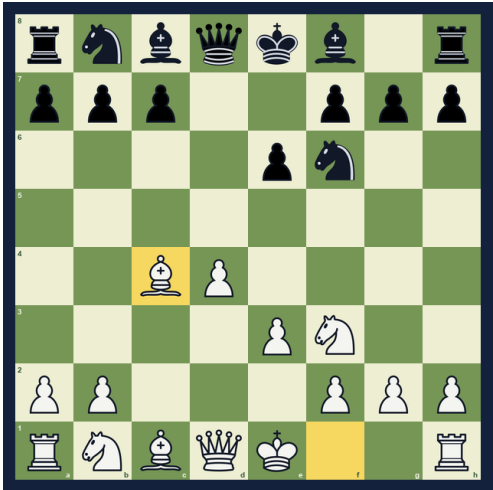
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

02. Checks, Captures, and Threats



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Forcing moves define the tactical boundary of the position.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

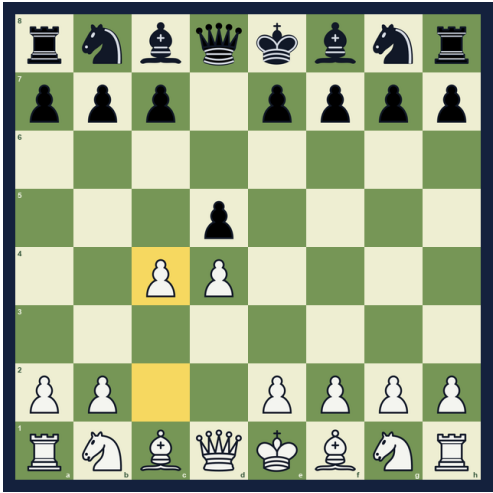
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

03. Calculate the Central Break



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

e4, e5, c5, and b5 change several lines at once.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

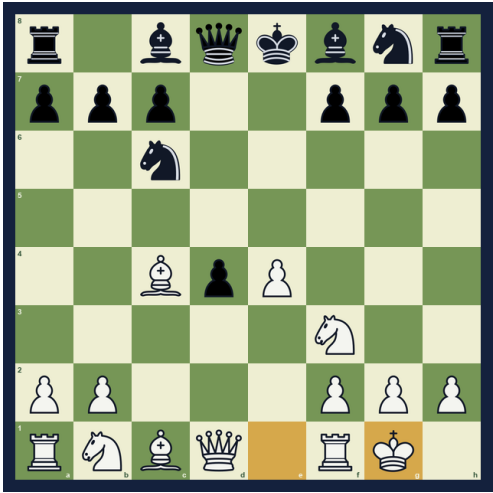
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FORECAST	__ / 2

04. The cxd5 Decision



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Capturing on d5 changes the c-file, e-file, and pawn targets.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. e4 e5 4. Nf3 exd4 5. Bxc4 Nc6 6. O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

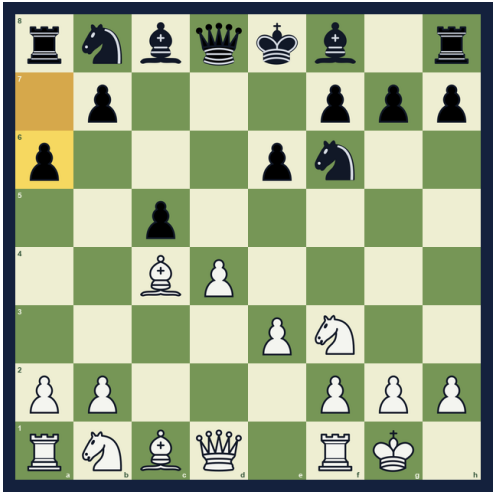
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CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

05. Choose the Right Recapture



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Pawn, knight, queen, or piece recaptures can create different structures.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

06. Punish a Pawn Grab



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Holding c4 or b5 can leave Black behind in development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Bg5 Be7 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd3 Nbd7 8. Qc2 Re8 9. Nge2 Nf8 10. O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

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FORECAST	__ / 2

07. Pins on c6 and f6



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

A pinned knight may still move when the piece behind it is not the king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Nf3 c6 6. Bg5 Be7 7. Qc2 O-O 8. e3 Nbd7 9. Bd3 Re8 10. O-O

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FORECAST	__ / 2

08. Qa4+ Geometry



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

A queen check can recover c4, attack c6, or force a blocking piece.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Nf3 c6 6. Bg5 Be7 7. Qc2 O-O 8. e3 Nbd7 9. Bd3 Re8 10. O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

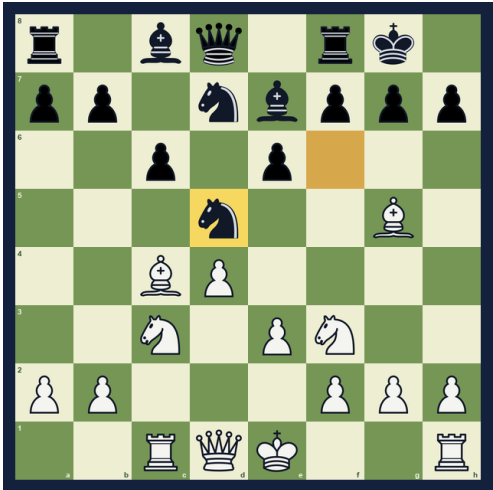
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

09. e4 and e5 Break Tactics



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Central pawn advances can fork pieces or open a bishop and rook simultaneously.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Nf3 Nbd7 7. Rc1 c6 8. Bd3 dxc4 9. Bxc4 Nd5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

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FORECAST	__ / 2

10. Long-Diagonal Tactics



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Fianchetto bishops create pins, skewers, and attacks on queenside rooks.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Nf3 h6 7. Bh4 b6 8. cxd5 exd5 9. Bd3 Bb7 10. O-O Nbd7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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FORECAST	__ / 2

11. Benko a-File Tactics



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Open queenside files allow rook sacrifices and pressure on b2.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Nf3 Nbd7 7. Rc1 c6 8. Bd3 dxc4 9. Bxc4 Nd5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
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FORECAST	__ / 2

12. King's Indian Sacrifices



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Closed centers often permit sacrifices on f2, g3, or h3.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. cxd5 exd5 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bh4 c5 8. e3 Nc6 9. Bd3 cxd4 10. exd4 O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

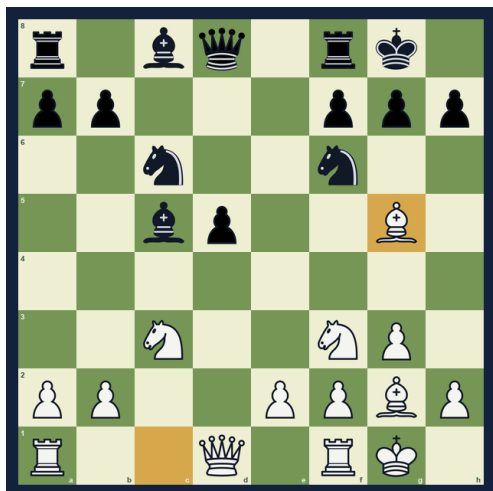
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

13. Clearance



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

A pawn advance or exchange can clear a file, diagonal, or square for another piece.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. g3 Nf6 7. Bg2 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. dxc5 Bxc5 10. Bg5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- ### 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

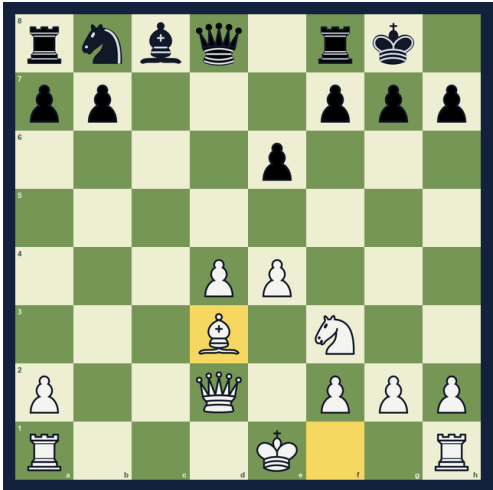
4. Which piece has the least useful job?

.....

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

14. Overload



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

A defender can be responsible for a pawn, square, and tactical line at once.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. e4 Nxc3 7. bxc3 cxd4 8. cxd4 Bb4+ 9. Bd2 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 O-O 11. Bd3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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FORECAST	__ / 2

15. Deflection



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

A forcing move can pull a piece away from the center or king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Na6 6. e4 Bg4 7. Bxc4 e6 8. O-O Be7 9. Be3 O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

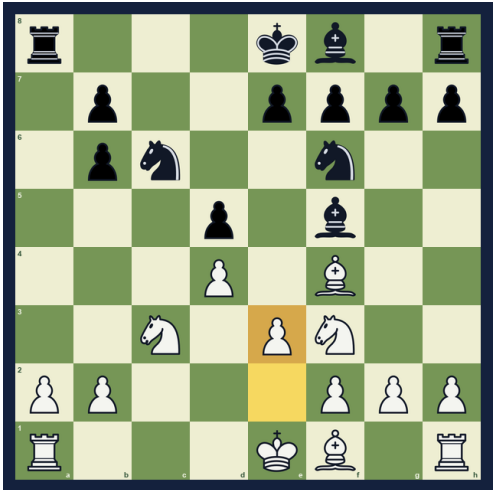
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

16. Intermediate Moves



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

An in-between check, capture, or threat can change an expected recapture sequence.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 Bf5 5. cxd5 cxd5 6. Qb3 Qb6 7. Qxb6 axb6 8. Bf4 Nc6 9. e3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

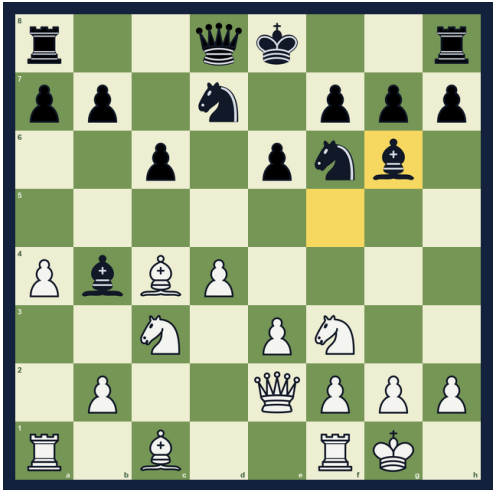
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

17. Generate Serious Candidates



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

A useful candidate comes from forcing moves, the structural plan, or Black's best resource.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Bf5 6. e3 e6 7. Bxc4 Bb4 8. O-O Nbd7 9. Qe2 Bg6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

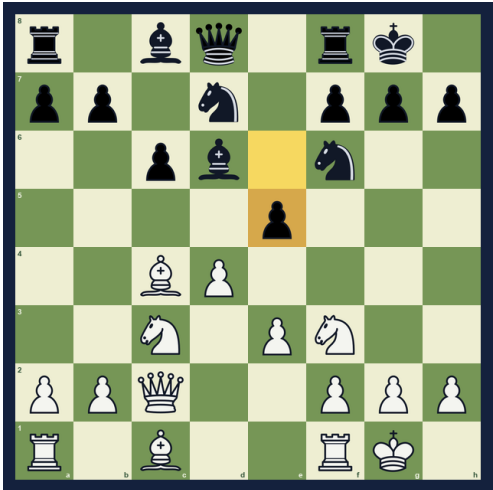
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

18. Visualize the Final Position



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Calculation fails when pieces from earlier branches remain in the mental picture.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Qc2 Bd6 7. Bd3 O-O 8. O-O dxc4 9. Bxc4 e5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

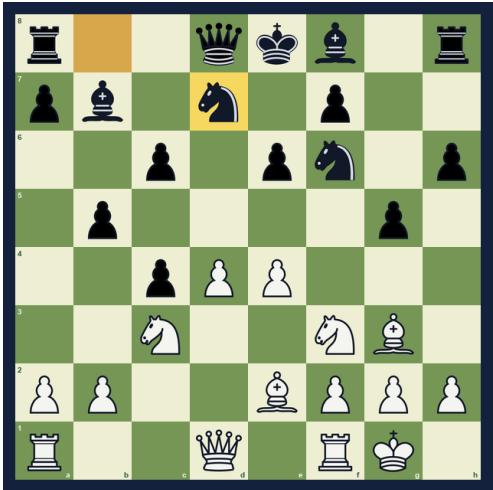
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

19. Know When to Stop



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

Calculation should stop when one safe move satisfies the plan against Black's best reply.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. Bg5 h6 6. Bh4 dxc4 7. e4 g5 8. Bg3 b5 9. Be2 Bb7 10. O-O Nbd7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

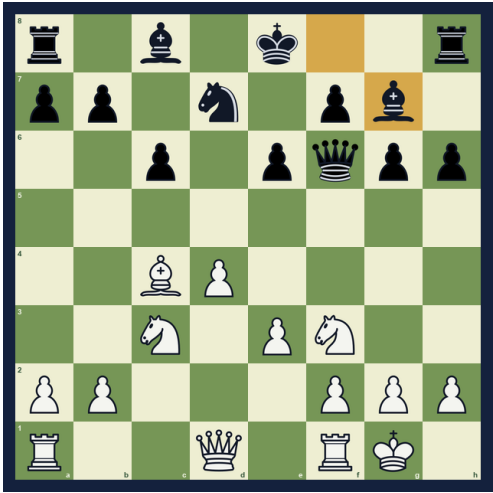
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PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

20. Final Blunder Check



TACTICS AND CALCULATION

POSITION PROMPT

The last scan catches hanging pieces and one-move tactical replies.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. Bg5 h6 6. Bxf6 Qxf6 7. e3 Nd7 8. Bd3 dxc4 9. Bxc4 g6 10. O-O Bg7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

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THREAT	__ / 2
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

Monthly Retention Audit

Select ten random chapters and complete them under a ten-minute total limit. Track the categories you repeatedly miss: threat, candidate, structure, piece job, or forecast.

Do not restart the entire course. Return to the smallest group of chapters that repairs the repeated error, then test again in one week.